U.S. DEPARTMENT OF ENERGY'S
CYBERFORCE® PROGRAM

CyberForce® 101

Green Team

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CyberForce Competition® Overview

The CyberForce Competition® is an in-person competition that provides collegiate students with a cyber-physical hands-on, realistic energy-based scenario to secure and defend that incorporates life-like constraints and tasks, actual end users, and continual emerging threats. Students are challenged by the opportunity to apply classroom knowledge in a real-life practical environment.

The goal is to build the pipeline of qualified cybersecurity candidates for crucial positions such as those in our energy sector, national laboratories, and industry. The CyberForce Competition provides an inclusive space for all participants, including collegiate students, mentors, industry, and academia.

Green Team Overview

The Green team scoring is one of the five scored areas within the CyberForce Competition®. It focuses on the usability, accessibility, and functionality of the web services provided to the competitors.

Who is the Green Team?

The Green team is comprised of volunteers from diverse backgrounds, with a variety of skill sets ranging from computer technical to non-experienced users to emulate an actual end-user. On the day of the competition, the Green team is responsible for evaluating the Blue teams' web services and system operability through the use of quality checking their website.

Value Add for Green Score

The purpose behind this particular area of the competition scoring is to provide competitors the opportunity to ensure their websites are accurate, thorough, and usable. While quick and timely website creation may be keen, there are more mistakes that can occur with more potential issues down the road that potential threat actors could utilize.

Competitors will be provided the same directions that the Green users will be using and should validate that their website is running accurately so that all questions would be stated in a positive way.

Recommendations

1. Conduct Testing. Whether participating in the CyberForce Competition or building your own website or something else, ensure you do thorough testing. Develop user testing guides and have someone run through them to see if the appropriate interactions are there.
2. Make changes. Make the necessary changes prior to having the website or page go live. If something was meant to be on the left but is shown on the right, this could cause large problems to users. This reduces headache and issues later. If the interactions were favorable but feedback indicated another potential method for ease, check to see if that would solve an issue.
3. Validate all security measures are followed. Prior to finishing your site, ensure you are abiding by security measures such as password requirements, etc.
4. Retest Ensure that any changes that you have made are following the initial testing document since edits and changes can cause other things to break along the way.

5. **Always Validate against the Provided Test.** Remember the testing phase is where you can ensure you have passed all the tests necessary for quality assurance and quality control.